



REVIEW

A TRISTAR ADVENTURE

IN A HARMONIOUS BLEND OF LEGACY AND INNOVATION, THE NEW MERCEDES-BENZ GLC PROMISES TO TAKE YOU ON AN EXHILARATING JOURNEY EVERY TIME YOU STEP INTO IT

BY CHETAN BHUTANI

SURROUNDED BY THE historic splendour of Karnataka's Hampi, where tales of antiquity still hold sway, a modern legend, the new Mercedes-Benz GLC, takes to the road like a fish takes to water. Enveloped in this cocoon of comfort, I embark on a journey through Hampi's enigmatic alleys and swift highways, powered by the innovative technology of this high-end SUV.

The convergence of comfort and technology in this vehicle delivers a captivating driving experience that lets you go to any locale and explore it with unmatched power, amazing presence and drool-worthy élan. The GLC's contemporary design, enhanced by the texture of fine leather and cutting-edge engineering, hints at the adventure one is embarking on every time one gets into the car.

The GLC navigates effortlessly through winding roads and alleyways, with superb acceleration. And it gives you the kind of exhilarating performance you'd expect from a top German-engineered vehicle. Its responsive handling lets you manoeuvre every curve, twist and turn as gracefully as a gymnast aiming for a podium finish at the Olympics.

As I drive on the highways and back roads between the Virupaksha Temple and the Tungabhadra River, on whose banks Hampi is located, the GLC's versatility takes centre stage, effortlessly moving between rugged terrain and speedways. Navigating the formidable terrain is a cinch, all because of the sophistication of the GLC's suspension. On top of that, a panoramic sunroof provides an alluring view of the expansive sky.

As we zoom past the awe-inspiring landscape, the GLC—ex-showroom prices of which start from ₹73.5 lakh—commands undivided attention on the road. But you might take a while to get used to the avant-garde digital interface, which trades buttons for a touch-based approach. The cabin, however, cocoons its occupants in comfort, while the firmness of the seats echoes the delicate balance between luxury and practicality.

As our drive comes to a close, one thing is clear: the Mercedes-Benz GLC is a true embodiment of modern engineering as it seamlessly combines automotive heritage with cutting-edge innovation to deliver a memorable experience. **BT**

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